

Request for Supplier Qualifications (RFSQ) Prequalification

For Information Management Technology Consulting Services

Request for Supplier Qualifications No.: RFSQ-0586-1

Issued Date: **September 13, 2023**

Response Deadline Date: **February 29, 2028**

Note: This RFSQ is a continuous onboarding process. The prequalified supplier(s) from RFSQ-0586 will not be required to submit a response to this continuous response process.

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PART 1 - INVITATION AND RESPONSE INSTRUCTIONS

1.1 Invitation to Proponents

This Request for Supplier Qualifications (RFSQ) is an invitation by the Government of Saskatchewan (GOS) to prospective Proponents *to pre-qualify* for the provision of Information Management Technology Consulting Services *on an “as required” basis*.

The Ministry of SaskBuilds and Procurement (SBP) helps build strong communities and a strong economy through the design and delivery of infrastructure, procurement, IT and logistics services and solutions for the Government of Saskatchewan. The ministry procures, manages and operates critical infrastructure government relies on to deliver essential public services for citizens. The Information Technology Division (ITD) within SBP facilitates the provisioning of secure business applications and technologies through vendor partners in support of the delivery of government services in the public interest.

The current Government of Saskatchewan contract for technical services related to operational reporting and analytics is expiring and the ministry requires related consulting services to continue to be delivered. ITD seeks to support the government organizations it serves with the goal to enhance the quality of decision making for government programs and delivery of services to citizens through continuous improvements to data management and analytics.

The intent of this RFSQ is to have a list of prequalified consultants where GOS can efficiently acquire data management and analytics consulting services. These services will be provided by industry specialists or subject matter experts that have the capability to provide advice and consulting to address GOS data management needs as they are identified. To be clear, this process is to establish a list of pre-qualified vendors, no financial commitments are being made in this RFSQ; subsequent competitive processes will follow as needs are identified.

Proponents are invited to provide submissions, in accordance with the terms, conditions and proposal response format as specified in this RFSQ, for the pre-qualification of one (1) or more of the following categories of consulting services as further described in **Appendix A - RFSQ Particulars, Section B – The Deliverables**. The high-level service categories include:

1. Data Governance
2. Business Transformation
3. Data Management Support
4. Analytics: Reporting and Business Intelligence (BI) Dashboards
5. Advanced Analytics: Data Science, AI/ML
6. Data Integration and Interoperability

Important Notice to Proponents:

These services are intended to provide “add-on” consulting services that are related to and will support the technology platform services to be acquired through the related procurement [RFP-0575 Information Management Technology Platform]. The “add-on” consulting services could range from short term assistance for the Ministries on specific data topics to specific and larger data management projects and initiatives. The details of how this RFSQ relates to the associated RFP are further described in **Appendix A – RFSQ Particulars, Section A – Background** below.

1.2 RFSQ Contact

Direct any questions regarding this competition to:

BTSProcurement@gov.sk.ca

Attention: Sheryl Plysiuk-Kolish, RFSQ-0586-1

Proponents and their representatives are not permitted to contact any employees, officers, agents, elected or appointed officials or other representatives of GOS, other than the RFSQ Contact, concerning matters regarding this RFSQ. Failure to adhere to this rule may result in the disqualification of the Proponent and the rejection of the Proponent's Response.

Inquiries and their Responses may be posted on the website sasktenders.ca at the sole discretion of the GOS, without revealing the source of the inquiry.

1.3 Type of Agreement for Deliverables

Selected Proponents may be invited to enter into an agreement in the form set out in Appendix C (the "Master Terms and Conditions"), which will govern the potential subsequent agreement of the Deliverables pursuant to invitational second stage competitive processes.

Responses will be evaluated in accordance with the evaluation process set out in Part 2 of the RFSQ. Based on the evaluation of Responses, those that meet the pass threshold outlined in Section D of Appendix A will be selected for inclusion on a prequalified list of suppliers that are eligible to participate in an invitational second stage competitive process for the potential provision of the Deliverables to GOS ministries, agencies, crown corporations, First Nations schools, and municipalities, academia, schools, or health care organizations (MASH).

Proponents that have not passed the threshold, and are not qualified through this process, may be eligible to re-qualify.

1.3.1 Continuous Prequalification Process

This pre-qualification will be posted to SaskTenders as a continuous onboarding process for additional Respondents of RFSQ-0586, for the remaining length of the RFSQ term. The same terms and conditions, qualifications, requirements and evaluation processes set out in the initial RFSQ document will apply to all Respondents. In this onboarding RFSQ, evaluation and selection of Respondents will occur quarterly or at the discretion of GOS from the Issue Date of RFSQ onboarding until the onboarding process ends. The onboarding process is expected to continue until six (6) months prior to expiration of the RFSQ term, and questions will be answered continuously through the onboarding process.

Respondents that are not qualified through this process, will not be eligible to re-qualify until three (3) months after their last Submission.

The prequalified supplier list resulting from this prequalification process will be in effect **from the date of commencement for five (5) years**.

The GOS reserves the right to remove prequalified supplier(s) that do not perform in accordance with the requirements set out in the second-stage competition(s) and in their response.

The prequalified supplier list will be utilized with the following process for usage:

- For orders up to \$25,000
Public entities may contact one supplier on the list for the supply of consulting services. However, it is recommended that more than one (1) supplier on the list be contacted for a quote so that pricing and offerings can be compared. The supplier should be selected based on best value to government.
- For orders from \$25,001 to \$75,000
Public entities are required to contact a minimum of three (3) suppliers on the list for a quote for the supply of consulting services. The supplier should be selected based on best value to government.
- For orders over \$75,001+
Public entities are required to contact all suppliers on the list within an applicable category, for a quote for the supply of consulting services. The supplier should be selected based on best value to government.

Proponents which are prequalified pursuant to this RFSQ are not guaranteed any volume of goods or service subsequent to this RFSQ, as all orders will be on an “as required basis”.

GOS reserves the right to engage other suppliers through additional competitive processes should it be deemed in the best interest of GOS to do so.

As part of the GOS audit process, prequalified suppliers may be required to complete a survey at the end of each term, in order to verify participation and usage.

1.4 RFSQ Timetable

Issue Date of RFSQ	September 13, 2023
Deadline for Questions	Ongoing
Deadline for Issuing Addenda	Ongoing
Response Submission Deadline	February 29, 2028
Rectification Period	3 days after notification
Anticipated Evaluation and Selection of Respondents	Ongoing quarterly or at the discretion of GOS

The RFSQ timetable is tentative only and may be changed by GOS at any time.

1.5 Responses

1.5.1 Responses

Proponents must submit by email.

The GOS does not assume any responsibility for delayed or rejected Responses. Proponents acknowledge that all risks associated with Responses are their sole responsibility, and that late Responses, regardless of the reason, will be rejected.

If there are multiple Responses received from a Proponent, the last email copy submitted will prevail.

The Initial Response Submission Date is outlined in Section 1.4 – RFSQ Timetable.

Responses by email:

One (1) electronic copy in .pdf, .doc or .docx, excel format, which includes the RFSQ reference number and closing date, are to be forwarded to:

response@gov.sk.ca

The subject line of the email should contain the competition reference number, competition title and company name (example: RFSQ 0586-Title-Company Name).

One (1) email, including attachments, should not be larger than 25MB or it may not be successfully transmitted. It is recommended to send one (1) email, however, if sending multiple emails, provide clear instructions on how the Submission is intended to be integrated.

Email submissions with links to a cloud-based storage system (i.e. Dropbox, Google Drive, OneDrive) will not be accepted.

Executable file formats such as .exe will not be accepted. The preferred file formats are .pdf, .doc, .docx, .xls and .xlsx.

The received time in the recipient's email inbox will be the recorded date and time of Submission. The GOS will provide confirmation of email receipt to Proponents via an automatic email message. If no confirmation email is received, please contact 306-787-6871.

Prior to closing, GOS will maintain confidentiality of email Submissions subject to the GOS officials opening an email for the purpose of identification. In the event that one (1) or more files cannot be opened (e.g., are corrupted), the Proponent will not have an opportunity to resend such files after closing.

For more information, refer to the document *Guidelines for Proponent Responses via Email on SaskTenders*.

1.5.2 Responses to be Received on Time

Responses must be received at the email address set out above on or before the Response Deadline. Responses received after the Response Deadline will not be accepted.

Onus and responsibility rests solely with the Proponent to submit its Response to the exact email address indicated in this RFSQ on or before the Response Deadline. GOS does not accept any responsibility for Responses submitted to any other email address by the Proponent or its delivery agents. Proponents are advised to make Responses well before the deadline. Proponents making Responses near the deadline do so at their own risk.

1.5.3 Amendment of Responses

Proponents may amend their Responses prior to the Response Deadline by submitting the amendment to the email address set out above. Any amendment should clearly indicate the RFSQ title and number, and which part of the Response the amendment is intended to amend or replace.

1.5.4 Withdrawal of Responses

At any time prior to the execution of a written Agreement for provision of the Deliverables, a Proponent may withdraw a Response. To withdraw a Response, a notice of withdrawal must be received by the

RFSQ Contact and should be signed by an authorized representative of the Proponent. GOS is under no obligation to return withdrawn Responses.

[End of Part 1]

PART 2 - EVALUATION OF RESPONSES

2.1 Stages of Evaluation

GOS will conduct the evaluation of Responses in the following stages:

2.2 Stage I – Requirements

GOS will review Response components for administrative deficiencies and compliance with mandatory requirements.

Administrative Deficiencies

If GOS determines that a proposal fails to meet any of the mandatory or submission requirements, GOS may at its discretion offer a rectification process. If a proposal fails to satisfy any of the mandatory or submission requirements, GOS may issue the proponent a rectification notice identifying the deficiencies and providing the proponent an opportunity to rectify the deficiencies. If the proponent fails to respond or to satisfy those mandatory or submission requirements within the Rectification Period, the proposal will be assessed on the initial proposal or eliminated from the process at GOS's direction. The Rectification Period will begin to run from the date and time that GOS issues a rectification notice to the proponent. The mandatory and submission requirements are set out in Appendix D and Appendix A, Section F respectively.

GOS may eliminate mandatory requirements unmet by all Proponents.

2.3 Stage II – Written Evaluation

GOS will evaluate each qualified Response on the basis of the rated criteria as set out in Appendix A.

The term “requirement” “shall” “must” (or similar term used in this RFSQ) is used for convenience only and is not intended to imply that any Response that does not exactly match or meet such a “requirement” will necessarily be disqualified. Instead, as part of the evaluation process, Proponents, goods, and services will be evaluated based on the extent to which, and how well, they are able to satisfy the intent, fit for purpose, and substance of the “requirements” or “specifications” contained in this RFSQ.

2.4 Ranking and Selection

Based on the evaluation of the Responses that meet the mandatory requirements in Stage II, GOS intends to select the **three (3)** highest scoring Proponents, per category. GOS may choose to select additional Proponents if their total score is within 10% of the highest scoring Proponent. GOS may select fewer than the three (3) highest scoring Proponents per category by choosing not to select Proponents with a total score that is not within 15% of the total score of the highest scoring Proponent. GOS will determine how many Proponents, if any, will be included on the prequalified supplier list.

2.5 Stage III – Interviews/Presentations and Reference Checks

Top-ranked Proponent(s) may be invited to participate in the interview/presentation and reference check stage.

2.5.1 Interview/Presentation (Optional)

Top-ranked Proponent(s) may be required to attend an interview or make a presentation to the Evaluation Team. The interview can include a presentation. Materials prepared by the top-ranked Proponent for the interview/presentation shall be provided to the Evaluation Team.

The interview/presentation is intended to verify that the proposed approach or services meet all the requirements and provides the Evaluation Team some exposure to the designated Proponent organization or service team.

The interview/presentation may also be used to clarify any portion of the written Response, if required.

The Evaluation Team will ask questions about the contents of the Proponent or presentation for clarification purposes. Clarifications made by the Proponent during the interview/presentation will become part of the Proponent's Response and may be included in any contract negotiations.

2.5.2 Reference Checks (Optional)

Reference checks may be completed for the Proponent and/or their proposed resources and sub-contractors.

During reference checks, GOS reserves the right to contact any of the Proponent's customers who GOS believes may be able to provide information about the Proponent that would be pertinent to this RFSQ.

The GOS reserves the right to conduct reference checks at any time during the RFSQ process.

Proponents who receive unfavourable references, in the opinion of the GOS, may have their proposal rejected.

[End of Part 2]

PART 3 - TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE RFSQ PROCESS

3.1 General Information and Instructions

3.1.1 Proponents to Follow Instructions

Proponents should structure their Responses in accordance with the instructions in this RFSQ. Where information is requested in this RFSQ, any response made in a Response should reference the applicable section numbers of this RFSQ.

3.1.2 Responses in English

All Responses are to be in English only.

3.1.3 No Incorporation by Reference

The entire content of the Proponent's Response should be submitted in a fixed form, and the content of websites or other external documents referred to in the Proponent's Response but not attached may not be considered to form part of its Response. If Proponents wish to reference websites or external documents, they should obtain the approval of the RFSQ Contact prior to the Response Date.

Proponents are responsible for ensuring that all external content that is referenced is accurate and are to provide notice to GOS of any changes that may arise after Response. GOS may, at any time, require a Proponent to provide a hard copy of some or all of the external content referenced.

3.1.4 References and Past Performance

In the evaluation process, GOS may consider information provided by the Proponent's references and may also consider information independently obtained by GOS about the Proponent or its Response in the course of GOS's own due diligence, including any previous dealings or experience, if any, with a Proponent. GOS may contact any of the Proponent's customers who GOS believes may be able to provide information about the Proponent that would be pertinent to this RFSQ.

3.1.5 Information in RFSQ Only an Estimate

GOS and its advisers make no representation, warranty or guarantee as to the accuracy of the information contained in this RFSQ or issued by way of addenda. Any quantities shown or data contained in this RFSQ or provided by way of addenda are estimates only and are for the sole purpose of indicating to Proponents the general scale and scope of the Deliverables. It is the Proponent's responsibility to obtain all the information necessary to prepare a Response to this RFSQ.

3.1.6 Proponents to Bear Their Own Costs

The Proponent will bear all costs associated with or incurred in the preparation and presentation of its Response, including, if applicable, costs incurred for interviews or demonstrations.

3.1.7 Response to be Retained by GOS

GOS will not return the Response, or any accompanying documentation submitted by a Proponent.

3.1.8 Trade Agreements

Proponents should note that procurements falling within the scope of one or more of:

- The New West Partnership Trade Agreement;
- The World Trade Organization Agreement on Government Procurement;
- Chapter 19 of the Canada – European Union Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement, including its incorporation by reference into the Agreement on Trade Continuity between the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland and Canada;
- Chapter 15 of the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership; or
- Chapter 5 of the Canadian Free Trade Agreement;

are subject to those trade agreements, but that the rights and obligations of the parties will be governed by the specific terms of this RFSQ.

3.1.9 No Guarantee of Volume of Work or Exclusivity of Agreement

This RFSQ process will not result in any commitment by GOS to purchase any goods or services from any Proponent. While GOS intends to conduct an invitational second-stage competitive process for the procurement of the Deliverables, it is under no obligation to do so and GOS may, in its sole and absolute discretion, choose not to proceed with a second-stage competitive process for the procurement of the Deliverables. GOS makes no guarantee of the value or volume of Deliverables that may be required. Any Agreement entered into pursuant to an invitational second-stage competitive process will not be an exclusive contract for the provision of the described Deliverables. GOS may contract with others for goods and services the same as or similar to the Deliverables or may obtain such goods and services internally.

3.1.10 Evaluation Committee

Evaluation of Responses will be by a committee formed by the GOS, which may include employees, consultants, and contractors of GOS.

3.2 Communication after Issuance of RFSQ

3.2.1 Proponents to Review RFSQ

Proponents should promptly examine all of the documents comprising this RFSQ and may direct questions in writing or seek additional information to the RFSQ Contact on or before the Deadline for Questions. No such communications are to be directed to anyone other than the RFSQ Contact. GOS is under no obligation to provide additional information, and GOS is not responsible for any information provided by or obtained from any source other than the RFSQ Contact. It is the responsibility of the Proponent to seek clarification from the RFSQ Contact on any matter it considers to be unclear. GOS is not responsible for any misunderstanding on the part of the Proponent concerning this RFSQ or its process.

3.2.2 All New Information to Proponents by Way of Addenda

This RFSQ may be amended only by addendum in accordance with this section. If GOS, for any reason, determines that it is necessary to provide additional information relating to this RFSQ, such information

will be communicated to all Proponents by addendum. Any information obtained in a method other than an addendum should not be relied upon. Each addendum forms an integral part of this RFSQ and may contain important information, including significant changes to this RFSQ. Proponents are responsible for obtaining all addenda issued by GOS.

3.2.3 Post-Deadline Addenda and Extension of Response Deadline

If GOS determines that it is necessary to issue an addendum after the Deadline for Issuing Addenda, GOS may extend the Response Deadline for a reasonable period of time.

3.2.4 Verify, Clarify and Supplement

When evaluating Responses, GOS may at its sole discretion request further information from the Proponent or third parties in order to verify, clarify or supplement the information provided in a Response. The Response received by GOS shall, if accepted by GOS, form an integral part of the Proponent's Response.

GOS may consider information independently obtained by GOS about the Proponent or its Response in the course of GOS's own due diligence, including any previous dealings or experience by it or others, if any, with a Proponent.

3.2.5 Time Disputes

In the event of a dispute regarding time, GOS's time clock will govern.

3.3 Notification and Debriefing

3.3.1 Notification to Successful Proponents

The successful Proponents selected by GOS to be included on a prequalified suppliers list in accordance with the process set out in the Evaluation of Responses (Part 2) will be so notified by GOS.

3.3.2 Notification to Other Proponents

Once the selected Proponents have been notified, the other Proponents will be notified by GOS of the outcome of the RFSQ process.

3.3.3 Debriefing

Proponents who provide a Response may request a debriefing after receipt of a notification of the outcome of the procurement process. All requests must be made in writing to the RFSQ Contact within thirty (30) calendar days of such notification. The intent of the debriefing information session is to aid the Proponent in presenting a better Response in subsequent procurement opportunities.

3.4 Conflict of Interest and Prohibited Conduct

3.4.1 Conflict of Interest

GOS may disqualify a Proponent or take any other action it deems appropriate in its sole discretion, for any conduct, situation or circumstances, determined by GOS, in its sole and absolute discretion, to constitute a Conflict of Interest.

For the purposes of this RFSQ, “Conflict of Interest” includes any situation or circumstance where, in relation to a GOS procurement competition, a participating Proponent has an unfair advantage, a perception of an unfair advantage or engages in conduct, directly or indirectly, that may give it an unfair advantage, including:

- (a) having, or having access to, information in the preparation of its Response that is not available to other Proponents, but such does not include information a Proponent may have obtained in the past performance of a contract with a public entity, including GOS, that is not related to the creation, implementation or evaluation of this or a related procurement competition;
- (b) communicating with any person with a view to influencing preferred treatment in this procurement competition (including but not limited to the lobbying of decision makers involved in this procurement competition); or
- (c) engaging in conduct that compromises, or could be seen to compromise, the integrity of the open and competitive procurement competition or renders that competition non-competitive, less competitive, or unfair.

All Proponents should advise GOS in writing whether it has any actual, potential or perceived Conflict of Interest, and if so, the nature of each Conflict of Interest. A Proponent may, in the sole discretion of GOS, be disqualified from this RFSQ process if a Proponent is found to have a Conflict of Interest.

3.4.2 Disqualification for Prohibited Conduct

GOS may disqualify a Proponent, terminate a contract subsequently entered into, or take such other action it may deem appropriate if GOS, in its sole and absolute discretion, determines that the Proponent has engaged in any conduct prohibited by this RFSQ.

3.4.3 Prohibited Proponent Communications

Proponents should not engage in any communications that could constitute a Conflict of Interest.

3.4.4 Proponent Not to Communicate with Media

Proponents should not at any time directly or indirectly communicate with the media in relation to this RFSQ or any Agreement entered into pursuant to this RFSQ without first obtaining the written permission of the RFSQ Contact.

3.4.5 No Lobbying

Proponents should not, in relation to this RFSQ or the evaluation and selection process, engage directly or indirectly in any form of political or other lobbying whatsoever to influence the selection of the Proponent(s).

3.4.6 Employee Responses

GOS employees (as a Proponent or a proposed resource) may be ineligible to enter into an Agreement.

3.4.7 Illegal or Unethical Conduct

Proponents are not to engage in any illegal business practices, including activities such as bid-rigging, price-fixing, bribery, fraud, coercion or collusion. Proponents are not to engage in any unethical conduct, including lobbying, as described above, or other inappropriate communications; offering gifts to any

employees, officers, agents, elected or appointed officials or other representatives of GOS; deceitfulness; providing Responses that contain misrepresentations or other misleading or inaccurate information; or any other conduct that compromises or may be seen to compromise the competitive process provided for in this RFSQ.

3.4.8 Past Performance or Past Conduct

GOS may prohibit a Proponent from participating in this or future procurement processes based on past performance or based on inappropriate conduct in a prior procurement process, including but not limited to the following:

- (a) illegal or unethical conduct as described above;
- (b) the refusal of the Proponent to honour its submitted pricing or other commitments; or
- (c) any conduct, situation or circumstance determined by GOS, in its sole and absolute discretion, to have constituted an undisclosed Conflict of Interest;
- (d) or otherwise outlined in the CFTA.

3.5 Confidential Information

3.5.1 Confidential Information of GOS

All information provided by or obtained from GOS in any form in connection with this RFSQ either before or after the issuance of this RFSQ

- (a) is the sole property of GOS and must be treated as confidential;
- (b) is not to be used for any purpose other than replying to this RFSQ and the performance of any subsequent Agreement for the Deliverables;
- (c) must not be disclosed without prior written authorization from GOS; and
- (d) must be returned by the Proponent to GOS immediately upon the request of GOS.

3.5.2 Confidential Information of Proponent

Responses will be accepted in confidence, as they contain financial, commercial, scientific, technical and/or labour relations information, except as may be otherwise provided herein. The confidentiality of such information will be maintained by GOS, except as otherwise required by law or by order of a court or tribunal, or by regulatory order of the Government of Saskatchewan, including but not limited to, the Crown Investment Corporation of Saskatchewan and other agencies or ministries of government including its boards, commissions or panels. Proponents are particularly advised that GOS is subject to legal requirements that may require disclosure of Response information including, without limitation, under *The Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act* (Saskatchewan). Notwithstanding the foregoing, GOS reporting requirements may result in the public disclosure of the Agreement to the Successful Supplier(s).

Proponents are advised that their Responses will, as necessary, be disclosed, on a confidential basis, to advisers retained by GOS, and/or to Crown corporations (as defined in *The Crown Corporations Act, 1993*) and GOS agencies or ministries, including its boards, commissions or panels, to advise or assist with the RFSQ process, including the evaluation of responses. If a Proponent has any questions about

the collection and use of personal information pursuant to this RFSQ, questions are to be submitted to the RFSQ Contact.

3.6 Procurement Process Non-binding

3.6.1 No Contract A and No Claims

This procurement process is not intended to create and will not create a formal, legally binding bidding process and will instead be governed by the law applicable to direct commercial negotiations. For greater certainty and without limitation:

- (a) this RFSQ will not give rise to any Contract A – based tendering law duties or any other legal obligations arising out of any process contract or collateral contract; and
- (b) neither the Proponent nor GOS will have the right to make any claims (in contract, tort, or otherwise) against the other with respect to the award of a contract, failure to award a contract or failure to honour a response provided in Response to this RFSQ.

3.6.2 Cancellation

GOS may cancel or amend the RFSQ process without liability at any time.

3.7 Governing Law and Interpretation

These Terms and Conditions of the RFSQ Process (Part 3):

- (a) are intended to be interpreted broadly and independently (with no particular provision intended to limit the scope of any other provision);
- (b) are non-exhaustive and must not be construed as intending to limit the pre-existing rights of the parties to engage in pre-contractual discussions in accordance with the common law governing direct commercial negotiations; and
- (c) are to be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the Province of Saskatchewan and the federal laws of Canada applicable therein.

[End of Part 3]

APPENDIX A - RFSQ PARTICULARS

A. BACKGROUND

The data management and analytics efforts within ITD have historically focused on establishing common technology services for the executive Ministries within the Government of Saskatchewan. This included the creation of the enterprise Operational Reporting Service (eORS) for establishing data repositories with basic query and reporting capabilities. Advanced analytics capabilities have also been pursued through cross-ministry collaboration. These investments have had various levels of adoption and success.

Continued research into industry practices as well as participation in public service organization discussions with peers across Canada have highlighted the need to focus beyond the delivery of common technologies. The critical success factors in reaching data and analytics objectives require focus in four key areas:

- Leadership and collaborative governance
- Organizational culture
- Data management competencies and capacity
- Service delivery and technology infrastructure

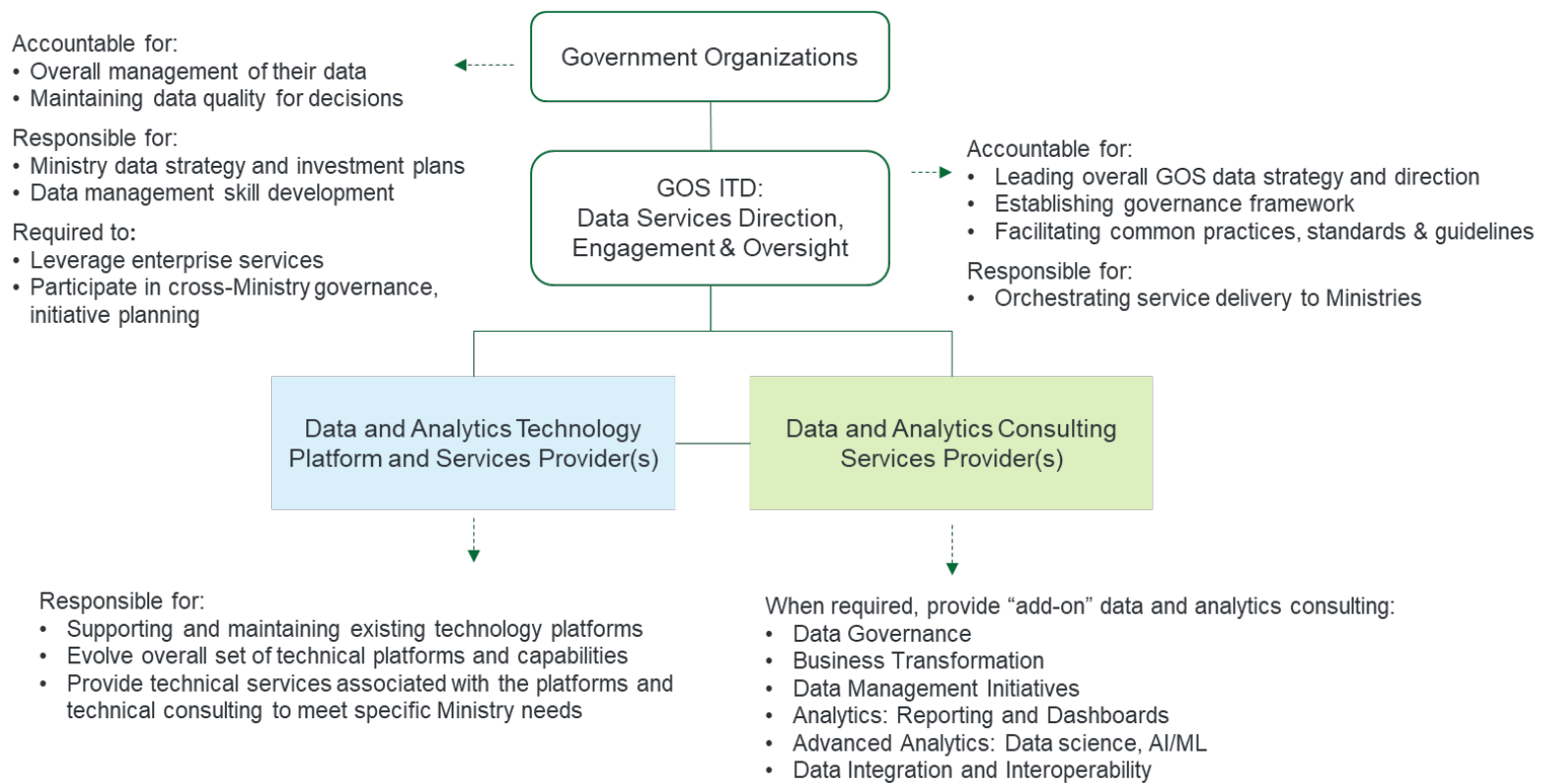
The current Government of Saskatchewan contract for service delivery and technology infrastructure for the operational reporting and analytics (eORS) environment is expiring. The approach for continuing these technical capabilities will include considerations for the broader set of critical capabilities highlighted above.

In addition to meeting current service delivery objectives, the on-going reporting and analytics capabilities of these services need to keep pace with innovation in both technical capabilities as well as common processes. This includes recognizing the opportunities for efficiency benefits in establishing common approaches and associated technical capabilities of managing data.

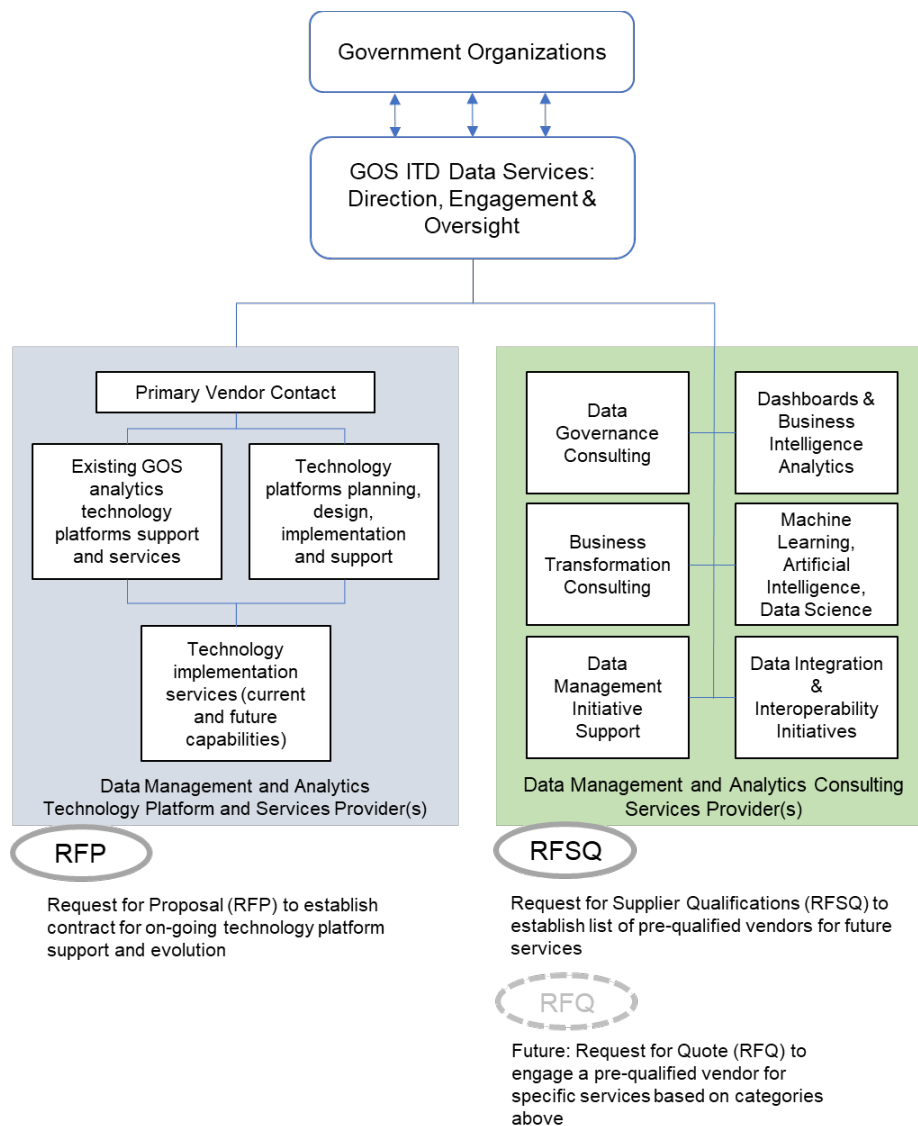
The continuous improvement in data management practices to maintain high data protection standards and responsible use requires further investments in data governance. To date, the technical services have focused on fundamental reporting, dashboards and analytics. Future value opportunities are envisioned with a broader set of capabilities including data stewardship, data quality management, data masking (anonymization), and advanced analysis.

These investments ultimately provide the ability to improve service delivery to the citizens in the province, the effectiveness of government programs, and economic outcomes envisioned in the 2030 Saskatchewan Growth plan.

In support of the outcomes and objectives for improved data management, as well as expanding access to IT Sector innovation and expertise, a new operating model has been envisioned within Saskatchewan. This includes relationships and interactions between the respective government organizations, GOS ITD, technology platform and data management and analytic consulting providers as depicted in the diagram below:



This RFSQ-0586 Information Management Technology Consulting Services, as well as the associated RFP-0575 Information Management Technology Platform seeks to enable the proposed operating model as depicted in the diagram that follows:



Proponents are encouraged to refer to the associated RFP-0575 Information Management Technology Platform to further understand the services expected under that Request for Proposals in context of this RFSQ. The resulting pre-qualified lists from this procurement process are designed to facilitate ministry requirements and allow users to obtain qualified support in a timely manner.

B. THE DELIVERABLES

The Government of Saskatchewan is seeking Proponents that can provide one (1) or more of the following categories for Information Management Technology Consulting Services on an “as required” basis:

B.1 Data Governance

B.2 Business Transformation

B.3 Data Management Support

B.4 Analytics: Reporting and Business Intelligence (BI) Dashboards

B.5 Advanced analytics: Data Science, AI/ML

B.6 Data Integration and Interoperability

The “as required” services may range from short term consulting on specific topic areas to larger project and initiative facilitation, participation and/or implementation.

For clarity, Proponents are encouraged to respond to each service category they feel qualified to provide. Proponents do not have to respond to all categories to qualify.

A service overview of each category is provided below, with further requirements in the service specific **Appendix I – Rated Criteria Spreadsheet**.

Proponents should note in responding to the specific sections, the follow criteria are considered important:

- **Experience:** Experience in engagements related to the services and deliverables mentioned.
- **Timeliness:** The Successful Supplier(s) will be able to demonstrate their ability to conduct the services in an efficient and timely manner, with particular attention to deadlines. This also includes the ability to provide depth in capacity, having the necessary skillsets, and capability to draw from.
- **Understanding our Industry:** The depth of knowledge of the industry (government sector) will be an important part of providing quality service.

Services Overview

B.1 Data Governance

The Government of Saskatchewan is seeking qualified Proponents to perform “Data Governance” related consulting services. This can include establishing direction, providing guidance oversight for the on-going practices involving roles, responsibilities, policies, standards, processes, procedures for using and managing data across the Government of Saskatchewan. Ultimately the efforts support evidence-based business decisions that achieve organizational outcomes.

The services and associated deliverables could include, but are not limited to:

- a) Designing an organization's enterprise data management framework of roles, responsibilities and practices, aligned with enterprise strategy and business architecture.
- b) Guiding and enhancing the development of cross organizational data governance working groups and decision authorities in charge of planning and determining initiative priorities including making recommendations for specific data management projects.
- c) Developing or refining data principles, policy, process/procedures (for legislative or regulatory compliance), rules, standards, and best practices.
- d) Facilitating, providing direction, guiding and assisting the development or refinement in one or more of the following key data management practice areas, including but not limited to:
 - **Accountability and data stewardship** – Establishing data trustees or custodians accountable or responsible for managing data quality, protection, access, reuse, and lifecycles. Guiding

business and Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) for co-ownership of responsibilities to deliver and maintain service levels to meet Ministry requirements.

- **Data privacy and protection** - Engaging with the respective government organization and IT Security team for aligning access controls, legislative and regulatory compliance, sensitivity classification, data masking, data encryption, and backup/recovery processes.
- **Data ethics** – Ensuring and maintaining practices for the ethical use and management of data, including:
 - Data practices for collecting, generating, analyzing and disseminating data to ensure compliance with regulatory requirements and rules for proper conduct.
 - Addressing and recommending concepts of right and wrong conduct with collecting, generating, analyzing and disseminating data owned by a citizen.
- **Data inventories and metadata management** – Establishing and publishing data catalogues and information used to categorize, classify and describe data repositories.
- **Data quality management** – Establishing or directing efforts to assess, improve, and implement maintenance controls to ensure data is current, accurate, complete, consistent, unique, and trusted.
- **Data lifecycle management** – Facilitating or refining data retention, archival, and disposition practices.
- **Master data management** – Facilitating, establishing and maintaining the core critical common data within the respective organizations.

B.2 Business Transformation

The Government of Saskatchewan is seeking qualified Proponents to perform “Business Transformation” consulting services associated with data management and analytics that enable change in business operations to achieve desired business outcomes.

The services and associated deliverables can include but are not limited to:

- a) Facilitating the development of innovative data strategies for current vs. future direction for managing data, and strategic roadmaps that drive effectiveness and deliver against the services and program outcomes of the Ministries.
- b) Develop business cases and funding requests, based on experience and supplier’s success stories, that identify business value opportunities within each Ministry data domain that improves their data management practices, and use of data in achieving their program objectives.
- c) Performing data maturity assessments of current (‘as-is’) state capabilities with managing data assets, and to specify the desired (‘to-be’) states that facilitate continuous improvement towards required levels of data management and analytics capabilities. Perform tactical planning to develop and maintain phased roadmaps of sequenced activities with dependencies and relationships.
- d) Assistance in increasing the maturity of current data cultures and data literacy, ensuring the respective organization is using evidence based data to derive insights for decision-making.
- e) Perform organizational change management (OCM) using concerted and collaborative efforts to achieve maturing data management practices. This includes establishing change management strategies, plans, educational materials and facilitating change across the Government of Saskatchewan.

- f) Consulting, coaching, mentoring, educating, training on data management disciplines to data practitioners within Ministries across the Government of Saskatchewan (as required).

B.3 Data Management Support

The Government of Saskatchewan is seeking qualified Proponents to perform “Data Management Support” services that design, plan, monitor, and improve data management functions and/or support specific projects and initiatives aligned to data management strategies.

The services and associated deliverables in support of specific business initiatives and project solutions can include but are not limited to:

- a) Expertise to introduce modern conceptual/logical architecture designs for data that utilizes and/or influences defined GOS technology platform services (aligned with RFP-0575 Information Management Technology Platform). This may include using current and/or establishing future patterns and models such as data products, Data as a Product (DaaP), data pipelines, data fabrics, data meshes, etc.
- b) Developing an inventory of data assets by data domain (subject) and increase overall data literacy and awareness. This includes documentation of architecture models, data assets and catalogs, attributes (such as sensitivity classifications), business glossaries, data dictionaries, information flows and data lineages.

B.4 Analytics: Reporting and Business Intelligence (BI) Dashboards

The Government of Saskatchewan is seeking qualified Proponents to provide services in support of projects and initiatives focused on fundamental reporting, descriptive analytics, diagnostic analytics and business intelligence dashboard development. Engaging with the respective government organization and the GOS data management and analytics service teams, the services and associated deliverables can include but are not limited to:

- a) Aligning data architecture and data analysis services that support current GOS enterprise data analytics service offerings (includes reporting and business intelligence dashboards). Consulting can include influencing further technical platform capability development for GOS technology platform services (provisioned through the associated RFP-0575 Information Management Technology Platform).
- b) Facilitating data preparation activities such as collection/capture/creation, discovery, combining, structuring, organizing, enriching, profiling, transforming, consolidating, and curating data in support of the analytics objectives.
- c) Providing expertise, guidance and knowledge transfer to the business in the use of Descriptive Analytics techniques (to describe the current situation and identify trends and patterns).
- d) Providing expertise, guidance and knowledge transfer to the business in the use of Diagnostic Analytics techniques (using historical data to discover the reasons for previous performance).

B.5 Advanced Analytics: Data Science, AI/ML

The Government of Saskatchewan is seeking qualified Proponents to provide services in support of projects and initiatives focused on advanced analytics initiatives including use of predictive, prescriptive, machine learning (ML) and/or artificial intelligence analytics capabilities. Engaging with the respective government organization and the GOS data management and analytics service teams, the services and associated deliverables can include but are not limited to:

- a) Aligning data architecture and advanced data analysis services that support current GOS enterprise data analytics service offerings (includes reporting and business intelligence dashboards). Consulting can include influencing further technical platform capability development for GOS technology platform services (provisioned through the associated RFP-0575 Data Management and Technology Platform Services).
- b) Facilitating data preparation activities such as collection/capture/creation, discovery, combining, structuring, organizing, enriching, profiling, transforming, consolidating, and curating data in support of the analytics objectives.
- c) Providing expertise, guidance and knowledge transfer to the business in the use of current GOS data science capabilities.
- d) Providing expertise, guidance and knowledge transfer to the business in the use of Predictive Analytics (using a variety of methods, such as forecasting, statistical modeling, analytical modeling, cognitive analysis, sentiment analysis and machine learning).
- e) Providing expertise, guidance and knowledge transfer to the business in the use of Prescriptive Analytics (using artificial intelligence, machine learning, algorithms, and business rules).

B.6 Data Integration and Interoperability

The Government of Saskatchewan is seeking qualified Proponents to provide services in support of projects and initiatives requiring data integration and/or data interoperability planning and implementation. Engaging with our GOS Integration service team by aligning data architecture and data analysis services that support our current enterprise data integration service offering, the services and associated deliverables can include but are not limited to:

- a) Planning and designing data integration and interoperability requirements.
- b) Facilitating data preparation activities such as collection/capture/creation, discovery, combining, structuring, organizing, enriching, profiling, transforming, consolidating, and curating data in support of the analytics objectives.
- c) Performing and supporting Extract, Transform, Load (ETL or ELT) processes.
- d) Performing and supporting Enterprise Information Integration processes (consolidating or amalgamating data).
- e) Engaging GOS Enterprise Application Integration services (exchanging data between applications using APIs, web services, service bus, etc.) as required.

MATERIAL DISCLOSURES

Once on the prequalified list, and after the invitational second stage competitive process (reference PART 1 section 1.3.1), the Successful Supplier(s) will be required to enter into contract.

For all categories, vendors will be expected to be able to conduct services on site when required. Travel costs will need to be pre-approved by GOS and paid out at current GOS rates.

C. MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS

The mandatory requirements are listed in APPENDIX D - MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS & SUBMISSION FORM.

D. RATED CRITERIA

The following is an overview of the categories and weighting for the rated criteria of the RFSQ. Proponents who do not meet a minimum threshold score may not proceed to the next stage of the evaluation process.

The following rated criteria need only be responded to once regardless of how many service categories are included in your Submission.

D.1 Proponent Profile	5	5%
D.2 Local / Industry Knowledge	20	20%
D.3 Technical Knowledge	10	10%
D.4 Proposed Approach to Service	10	10%
The following rated criteria need to be responded to for each service category included in your Submission		
D.5 Experience and Qualifications	30	30%
D.6 Capacity to Deliver	15	15%
D.7 Value Add-ons and Innovation	10	10%
Total Points	100	100%

D.1 Proponent Profile (5 Points)

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

D.1.1 Provide a brief introduction and overview of your company and its partnerships; particularly as they are related to the services outlined in **Appendix A Section B Deliverables** in this RFSQ.

D.1.2 Provide details of any and all subcontracting or partnership arrangements proposed by the Proponent specifically relating to the provision of Services as described herein. Outline the nature of the proposed involvement and the nature of the relationship.

D.1.3 Location of head office and any sub-offices.

NOTE: The information asked for above should be provided for all Proponents partners and sub-contractors included in Submission.

D.2 Local / Industry Knowledge (20 Points)

GOS and its Ministry stakeholders are interested in understanding the Service Provider's experience with the Government of Saskatchewan, or comparable entity, as it relates to the business of public service.

Specifically, proponents are asked to highlight any knowledge of existing Government of Saskatchewan Ministries or Organizations, Programs or Operations.

In addition, the Service Provider's current knowledge of Federal or Provincial Acts and Regulations pertaining to data is considered an asset as well.

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

D.2.1 Outline your organization's experience and knowledge of Government of Saskatchewan's (or comparable entity) business and operations. Indicate the relative timelines in which this experience and knowledge has been acquired.

D.2.2 Outline your organization's experience and knowledge of public service organizations (Federal, Provincial, Municipal, Boards, Agencies or non-Profit). Indicate the relative timelines in which this experience and knowledge has been acquired.

D.2.3 Outline your organization's experience and knowledge of applicable Acts, Regulations, and Policies (Federal or Provincial) relating to data management and protection. Indicate how recent this knowledge has been acquired.

D.2.4 Outline your organization's experience and knowledge of specific private industries you feel are relevant to the services requested.

D.3 Technical Knowledge (10 Points)

GOS and its Ministry stakeholders are interested in understanding the Service Provider's experience with the Government of Saskatchewan data management and analytics technology platforms, as well as knowledge modern and emerging technology capabilities and products in the solution industry. Familiarity with GOS technology products is considered an asset. Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

D.3.1 Outline your organization's experience in implementing and supporting IBM Infosphere data management and analytics solutions.

D.3.2 Outline your organization's experience in implementing and supporting IBM Cognos data management and analytics solutions.

D.3.3 Outline your organization's experience in implementing and supporting Microsoft Power BI data management and analytics solutions.

D.3.4 Outline your organization's experience in implementing and supporting ESRI ArcGIS Enterprise data management and analytics solutions.

D.3.5 Highlight any Gold Partner (or equivalent) status your organization has in any data management and analytics solutions

D.4 Proposed Approach to Service (10 Points)

RFSQ Appendix A, Section B Background describes the roles of the primary stakeholder groups within the envisioned operating model for a data management and analytics "ecosystem". This model includes the government organizations (services consumers), a government oversight group (ITD), a technology platform services provider, and the "as required" consulting services providers (this RFSQ).

As a consulting services provider, GOS is specifically interested in your organization's ability to develop strong relationships and cross collaboration with key stakeholders within vendor community, ITD, Ministries, Agencies.

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

D.4.1 Outline your approach for working within the envisioned operating model, indicating how you would approach relationship management and/or initiative oversight and governance.

D.4.2 Indicate your experience in working within a multi-vendor environment to achieve common outcomes and using Enterprise Technology Services defined within those environments.

D.5 to D.7 Service Categories Rated Criteria (total of 55 Points, each category)

As described in **Appendix A Section B Deliverables**, six categories of data management services have been defined. These include:

B.1 Data Governance

B.2 Business Transformation

B.3 Data Management Support

B.4 Analytics: Reporting and Business Intelligence (BI) Dashboards

B.5 Advanced analytics: Data Science, AI/ML

B.6 Data Integration and Interoperability

Proponents are requested to respond to the rated criteria for *any or all of* the six categories in which they have specific services that they can provide. *Proponents do not have to respond to all categories.* Proponents are asked to respond to the specific categories in which they wish to qualify for.

Details of the rated criteria (D.5 -D.7) for each service category are available in the six sections (individual tabs) of the Appendix I Rated Criteria Spreadsheet.

Generally, Responses that receive less than 70% of the points may be rejected after the evaluation of the written Response. The Evaluation Team will determine how many Responses, if any, will be short-listed.

Any Response ranked at the lower end of the scale in any of the criteria may be rejected.

E. OTHER RATED CRITERIA

Optional Rated Criteria Category (See PART 2)	Weighting (Points)
E.1 Interviews / Presentations	15
E.2 Reference Checks	15
Total Points	30

Details for Other Rated Criteria will be provided to top-ranked Proponents as outlined in PART 2 of this RFSQ.

F. RESPONSE GUIDELINES

Responses should also include all the information requested, and be presented, in the order described below:

Table of Contents

A listing of the Response contents with reference to the appropriate page number. Page numbering and tabs are beneficial.

Letter of Introduction

One page of introduction which should be dated and signed by an official authorized to negotiate, make commitments and provide clarifications with respect to the response on behalf of the Proponent.

Executive Summary

Provide a summary of the key features of your response.

Forms**Submission Form**

Each Response should include a Submission Form (Appendix B), or a document containing the information requested by the Submission Form, completed and signed by an authorized representative of the Proponent.

Rated Criteria

Proponents should include a response to each of the rated criteria (Section D of this Appendix and Appendix I attached to this competition) completed according to the instructions contained in the form.

APPENDIX C - FORM OF AGREEMENT

Proponents are asked to review Appendix C – Form of Agreement and state any requested deviations to this appendix as part of their submission. Suppliers that hold an active Ministry of SaskBuilds and Procurement (formerly Central Services) Master Terms and Conditions are not required to review this Appendix.

APPENDIX D - MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS & SUBMISSION FORM

1. Mandatory Requirements

Proponents should complete the following table:

The Proponent agrees to the following:	Yes	No	Pg.#
Mandatory #1 - Service providers are required to review Appendix C, Form of Agreement and agree to one of the following: 1.Yes, you accept the terms and conditions as outlined in the Appendix, or 2.You provide a markup with requested changes to the Appendix, or 3.You advise that you have a current SaskBuilds and Procurement (formerly Central Services) Master Terms and Conditions and agree that it will be used for any engagement resulting from this competition.			
Mandatory #2 - The Proponent confirms it has established Information Security Policies, Standards, and Specifications which align with ISO 27002:2013, or similar/equivalent, industry recognized code of practice for information security controls. These are outlined in Appendix G - Information Security			

2. Proponent Information

Please fill out the following form, naming one person to be the proponent's contact for the RFS process and for any clarifications or communication that might be necessary.	
Full Legal Name of Proponent:	
Saskatchewan Business Registration Number: (or equivalent)	
Any Other Relevant Name under which Proponent Carries on Business:	
Street Address:	
City, Province/State:	
Postal Code:	
Phone Number:	
Company Website (if any):	
Proponent Contact Name and Title:	
Proponent Contact Phone:	
Proponent Contact Email:	
For reporting purposes only, businesses that meet all the below criteria are asked to check the following box to declare as a Saskatchewan Business.	
☐ - Have a place of business in Saskatchewan. This place of business refers to an establishment where regular business activities are conducted on a permanent basis, is clearly identified by name and is accessible during normal business hours; • Employ Saskatchewan residents or sole proprietorship owned by a Saskatchewan resident; and • Be a registered business in Saskatchewan with an Information Services Corporation profile or equivalent.	
Physical Address of Saskatchewan Office:	☐ Same as Above ☐ Not Applicable ☐ Address (Provide Street, City, Postal Code):

The Proponent acknowledges the RFSQ process will be governed by the terms and conditions of the RFSQ, and that, among other things, such terms and conditions confirm that this procurement process does not constitute a formal, legally binding bidding process (and for greater certainty, does not give rise to a Contract A bidding process contract), and that no legal relationship or obligation regarding the procurement of any good or service will be created between GOS and the Proponent unless and until GOS and the Proponent execute a written Agreement for the Deliverables.

Signature of Proponent Representative

Title of Proponent Representative

Name of Proponent Representative

Date

APPENDIX E - DEFINITIONS

Throughout this RFSQ, the following definitions apply:

“Agreement” means the written contract between the top-ranked Proponent and His Majesty to provide the services contemplated by this RFSQ.

“Client” (referring to ministry) means His Majesty the King in the right of the Province of Saskatchewan, as represented by the Ministry of SaskBuilds and Procurement.

“Desirable” “Rated” “Should” means requirements that may have a degree of importance to be objectives of this RFSQ and may be rated.

“Deliverables” means the functions, duties, tasks and responsibilities to be provided by the Proponent as described in this RFSQ.

“Delivered Duty Paid” refers to a transaction where the seller pays for the total costs associated with transporting goods and is fully responsible for the goods until they are received and transferred to the buyer. This includes paying for costs, export and import duties, insurance and any other expenses incurred during shipping of the goods. The risks and charges are with the seller of the goods until delivery is made in the buyer’s country at an agreed-upon location.

“Entity” refers to the Government of Saskatchewan, the province or ministries are used for administrative purposes and mean His Majesty the King in Right of the Province of Saskatchewan, as represented by the Minister of SaskBuilds and Procurement.

“Evaluation Team” means the individuals who will evaluate the responses on behalf of the Government of Saskatchewan.

“GST” means Goods and Services Tax (currently at 5%).

“Mandatory” means requirements that are imperative and must be met in order for the response to receive consideration.

“Proponent” means an individual or a company that provides, or intends to provide, a response to this RFSQ.

“PST” means Saskatchewan Provincial Sales Tax (currently 6%).

“Response” means the bid, proposal, or document provided by a Proponent in Response to the RFSQ.

“RFSQ” means Request for Supplier Qualifications.

“Successful Proponent” means the organization responding to this RFSQ who is determined to be successful in this competition and has been added to the prequalified supplier list by GOS.

APPENDIX F - ITD ENVIRONMENT

The above-mentioned Appendix may be found as an attached document to this Competition. It lists ITD's technology information environment and should be taken in consideration while building your submission.

APPENDIX G - INFORMATION SECURITY

The above-mentioned Appendix may be found as an attached document to this Competition. It lists ITD's information security requirements and should be taken in consideration while building your submission.

APPENDIX H - INFRASTRUCTURE AND ARCHITECTURE

The above-mentioned Appendix may be found as an attached document to this Competition. It describes ITD's considerations in regard to the Solution's Infrastructure and Architecture requirements and should be taken in consideration while building your submission.

APPENDIX I – RATED CRITERIA

Rates Requirements is an attached spreadsheet describing the evaluation criteria for the desired elements of the solution/service from an information technology perspective. Your submission must contain the completed document in order to be evaluated.

APPENDIX J – NOT REQUIRED

APPENDIX K – NOT REQUIRED

APPENDIX L – REFERENCE COPY OF RFP-0575